DCTVU

DC TELEVISION UNIVERSE

Franchise Bible — Volume 05: The Lead Characters

FORMAT • TONE • CONTINUITY • CANON • TEAMS & FOUNDING ROSTERS

An alternate-history story told through Hollywood trades, headlines,
social media, the internet, and screenplay-format scenes.

Story present: 2010.
Six live-action series + two animated series. One multiverse.

Internal development document. Fictional actors and the individual series to be created in later volumes.

At a Glance

Each lead is the comic-accurate DC character who best fits that slot's job in the franchise. Series titles stay reserved for you; the character names are not titles.

Slot	Fills the role of	Lead character	Setting
Live-Action 1 (2012–2020)	Arrow	**Green Arrow** — Oliver Queen	Star City, main DCTVU Earth
Live-Action 2 (2014–2023)	The Flash	**The Flash** — Barry Allen	Central City, main DCTVU Earth
Live-Action 3 (2015–2021)	Supergirl	**Wonder Woman** — Princess Diana of Themyscira	Her own separate Earth → linked in S5
Live-Action 4 (2016–2022)	Legends of Tomorrow	**Justice Society of America** (ensemble)	Main DCTVU Earth, across time
Live-Action 5 (2018–2021)	Black Lightning	**Black Lightning** — Jefferson Pierce	His own separate Earth → joins in S3
Live-Action 6 (2019–2022)	Batwoman	**Batwoman** — Kate Kane	Gotham City, main DCTVU Earth
Animated 1 (2015–2016)	Vixen	**Green Lantern** — Hal Jordan	Main DCTVU Earth and space sector 2814
Animated 2 (2017–2018)	Freedom Fighters: The Ray	**Captain Marvel (Shazam)** — Billy Batson & the Marvel Family	Earth-S, a parallel Earth

The design behind the slate: together, the eight leads put **four of the seven Justice League founders** on screen as series leads (Flash, Wonder Woman, Green Lantern) or in a lead's supporting cast (Batman, in LA6). They also cover the premier team's tones: street level, science fiction, myth, cosmic, legacy, family, gothic, and pure wonder. By the 2019–20 peak year, the pieces are in place to assemble the Justice League of America on screen.

Live-Action 1 — GREEN ARROW (Oliver Queen)

First appearance	*More Fun Comics* #73 (Nov. 1941)
Comic-accurate core	Billionaire heir to Queen Industries who was stranded on an island and taught himself archery to survive. He comes home to Star City as a vigilante with trick arrows (boxing glove, net, explosive, grappling), and grows from a playboy into the DCU's outspoken social crusader. He wears the classic goatee and Robin Hood-style hood and costume, and he's called “Green Arrow” from day one.
Supporting cast	Black Canary (Dinah Lance), Speedy (Roy Harper), Connor Hawke, Wildcat (Ted Grant, Dinah's trainer)
Rogues	Merlyn, Count Vertigo, Brick, Clock King, Cupid, Onomatopoeia, Deathstroke

Why this character: The launch series has to start grounded and affordable, then build outward. Oliver Queen is a non-powered hero whose world naturally grows to include metahumans, magic, and the League, which he joins in the comics. In 2010, Warner Bros. is protecting Batman and Superman for its films (*The Dark Knight Rises*, the *Superman* reboot), so the most iconic street-level DC hero available for TV is Green Arrow. He also brings Black Canary, Roy Harper, and Wildcat, the bridge to the JSA in LA4.

Live-Action 2 — THE FLASH (Barry Allen)

First appearance	*Showcase* #4 (Oct. 1956)
Comic-accurate core	Central City police forensic scientist struck by lightning and chemicals, connecting him to the Speed Force. His mother Nora was murdered by the Reverse-Flash, and his father Henry was wrongly convicted (Johns's *Flash: Rebirth*, 2009). He can reach light speed, travel through time and across the multiverse, and vibrate through solid matter. Nothing is nerfed.
Supporting cast	Iris West, Wally West (Kid Flash), Jay Garrick (the Golden Age Flash), Captain Darryl Frye, Patty Spivot
Rogues	Reverse-Flash (Eobard Thawne), Captain Cold, Heat Wave, Mirror Master, Weather Wizard, Captain Boomerang, the Trickster, Gorilla Grodd, Zoom

Why this character: A founding member of the Justice League and DC's gateway to the multiverse and time travel. The Speed Force is the in-story engine that connects Earths, so every later crossover, Earth-hop, and the franchise's multiverse event runs through this show. Geoff Johns wrote *The Flash* and co-creates the series, so canon is in safe hands.

Live-Action 3 — WONDER WOMAN (Princess Diana of Themyscira)

First appearance	*All Star Comics* #8 (Dec. 1941/Jan. 1942)
Comic-accurate core	Demigod Amazon princess of Themyscira, daughter of Queen Hippolyta, who comes to Man's World as an ambassador of peace and a warrior. She has the Lasso of Truth, bracelets, tiara, sword and shield, flight, and strength on Superman's level. She's a diplomat and a warrior, and she's never nerfed.
Supporting cast	Steve Trevor, Etta Candy, Queen Hippolyta, the Amazons, Donna Troy (Wonder Girl), the Greek gods
Rogues	Ares, Cheetah (Barbara Minerva), Circe, Giganta, Doctor Psycho, Maxwell Lord, the Silver Swan

Why this character: This slot is a female-led powerhouse that premieres on CBS, starts on its own Earth, and joins the franchise later. Wonder Woman is the definitive choice: a founding member of the Justice League and one of DC's "Trinity" with Superman and Batman. Starting her on her own Earth, where she's the world's first and only superhero, gives her series a clean, epic launch. Her S5 crossover into the DCTVU is the event that completes the League's founding lineup.

Real-world note: in our 2010 present, a separate Wonder Woman TV pilot is being developed for NBC. In this alternate history, the DCTVU version can be what replaces it, which is a natural storyline for the trades.

Live-Action 4 — JUSTICE SOCIETY OF AMERICA (ensemble)

First appearance	*All-Star Comics* #3 (Winter 1940)
Comic-accurate core	The first superhero team. The Golden Age heroes of World War II disbanded in 1951 rather than unmask before Congress. Exposure to Ian Karkull's chronal energy kept the survivors young, so the 1940s veterans are still active today. They're mentoring a new generation of legacy heroes, as in Johns's *JSA* run (1999–).
Introduced in LA1 / LA2	**Wildcat** (Ted Grant) through Black Canary in LA1. **Jay Garrick** through Barry Allen in LA2. **Hourman** (Rick Tyler) and **Atom Smasher** also bridge in.
New characters	Alan Scott (Green Lantern), Hawkman and Hawkgirl, Doctor Fate, Doctor Mid-Nite, Mr. Terrific (Michael Holt), Stargirl (Courtney Whitmore), Sandman (Wesley Dodds)
Rogues	Vandal Savage, Per Degaton (a time-traveling villain), the Injustice Society, Black Adam, Gog

Why this character: This slot is an ensemble spinoff built from LA1 and LA2 characters plus new ones, and the show has a time-travel element. The JSA is the comic-accurate team made for that: a legacy team whose story spans 1940 to the present, with Golden Age flashbacks, time travel through Per Degaton and Vandal Savage, and members who can be introduced through Green Arrow's and the Flash's worlds. It's also one of our locked supporting teams, so this gives it a series.

Live-Action 5 — BLACK LIGHTNING (Jefferson Pierce)

First appearance	*Black Lightning* #1 (Apr. 1977)
Comic-accurate core	Olympic decathlete turned high-school teacher and principal in the Suicide Slum neighborhood. He's a metahuman who generates and controls electricity, a father, and a hero driven by community. He's also a founding member of Batman's Outsiders.
Supporting cast	His daughters Anissa Pierce (Thunder) and Jennifer Pierce (Lightning), Lynn Stewart, Peter Gambi
Rogues	Tobias Whale, the 100, Syonide, Cyclotronic Man

Why this character: The slot calls for a family-driven series on its own Earth with a distinct voice. Black Lightning is a mature, established hero and a father of two superhero daughters, the strongest family drama in DC's line. As a founding Outsider, he's the franchise's path to the Outsiders when he joins in S3, and the Akils give his show its own authorial identity.

Live-Action 6 — BATWOMAN (Kate Kane)

First appearance	*52* #7 (Aug. 2006); her modern origin in *Detective Comics* #854–860 (“Elegy,” 2009–10)
Comic-accurate core	An openly lesbian military cadet expelled from West Point under “Don't Ask, Don't Tell,” who becomes Gotham's Batwoman with the support of her father, Colonel Jacob Kane. She operates alongside Batman, as she does in the comics. Her twin sister Beth, believed dead, returns as the villain Alice.
Supporting cast	Colonel Jacob Kane, Maggie Sawyer, Renee Montoya (the Question), Flamebird (Bette Kane), and **Batman**
Rogues	Alice and the Religion of Crime, Medusa, the Hydrology arc, the Gotham rogues' gallery

Why this character: A 2019 launch in Gotham brings Batman's world to the franchise. Batwoman's “Elegy” arc is a self-contained gothic saga that fits a three-season run, and in 2010 she's one of DC's most acclaimed new characters. Because she works alongside Batman, as in the comics, LA6 is where the franchise can finally bring Batman, a JLA founder, onto the screen.

Animated 1 — GREEN LANTERN (Hal Jordan)

First appearance	*Showcase* #22 (Oct. 1959)
Comic-accurate core	Test pilot at Ferris Aircraft in Coast City, chosen by the dying Abin Sur. He's the Green Lantern of Sector 2814, with a power ring limited only by his willpower. His story moves between Earth, the planet Oa, and the Guardians of the Universe.
Supporting cast	Carol Ferris, Abin Sur, Sinestro, Kilowog, Tomar-Re, Guy Gardner, John Stewart, the Guardians
Rogues	Sinestro and the Sinestro Corps, Atrocitus, Star Sapphire, Hector Hammond, Parallax

Why this character: Animation is where the franchise can afford what live action can't. A JLA founder whose stories are cosmic space opera is exactly that. Johns's *Green Lantern* run is the blueprint, Bruce Timm brings unmatched DC animation experience, and Hal can appear in the live-action series as a voice or a special guest, joining the League at full power.

Animated 2 — CAPTAIN MARVEL / SHAZAM (Billy Batson)

First appearance	*Whiz Comics* #2 (Feb. 1940)
Comic-accurate core	Orphan newsboy Billy Batson says “SHAZAM!” and becomes Captain Marvel, the World's Mightiest Mortal, with the wisdom of Solomon, strength of Hercules, stamina of Atlas, power of Zeus, courage of Achilles, and speed of Mercury. He lives on **Earth-S**, the parallel Earth of the Fawcett heroes.
Supporting cast	Mary Marvel, Captain Marvel Jr. (Freddy Freeman), the Wizard Shazam, Uncle Dudley, Tawky Tawny
Rogues	Black Adam, Dr. Sivana, Mister Mind and the Monster Society of Evil, Mr. Atom, King Kull

Why this character: The slot calls for a series set primarily on a parallel Earth. Earth-S is one of DC's classic parallel worlds, and Captain Marvel has the raw power to match Superman. He's ideal for animation, can cross to the main DCTVU Earth for crossovers, and his archenemy Black Adam is also a JSA villain, which connects him to LA4.

Trademark realism: because Marvel owns the “Captain Marvel” trademark, the series would be titled *Shazam!* while the character remains Captain Marvel. That's accurate to DC's real 2010 situation.

The road to the Justice League: Flash (LA2), Wonder Woman (LA3, linked in 2019–20), Green Lantern (A1), and Batman (LA6, 2019) are established in their own series. Superman, Aquaman, and Martian Manhunter can be introduced in crossovers, and then the League assembles at the franchise's peak.